

Student Number _____



KINCOPPAL – ROSE BAY
SCHOOL OF THE SACRED HEART

Year 12

English Extension 1

Trial Examination

General Instructions

- Reading time - 10 minutes
- Working time – 2 hours
- Write in black pen

Total Marks
50

- Section I – 25 marks (pages 2-4)
- Attempt Question 1
- Allow about 1 hour for this question

- Section II – 25 marks (page 5-9)
- Attempt ONE question from Questions 2-6
- Allow about 1 hour for this question

Section I: Common Module – Literary Worlds

25 marks

Attempt Question 1

Allow about 1 hour for this question.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of the module and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question demonstrating control of the use of language
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In your responses to Part (a) and (b), draw on your understanding of the module Literary Worlds and the extracts provided.

(a) Use Text 1 and 2 to answer this part.

15 Marks

Evaluate how effectively, in the light of the extract from Text 1, Aman invites the reader into the world of the characters through the depiction of the ritual.

(b)

10 Marks

Compose a piece of imaginative writing that invites the reader into the world of the characters through the depiction of a ritual or celebration.

Excerpt from *Utopian Breakfasts: Margaret Atwood's MaddAddam*

Author: Shelley Boyd

***Beginnings and Stories Served with Breakfast* ~~**

Breakfast has long been known as the most important meal of the day, and for Canadian author Margaret Atwood, it happens to be her favorite. She once described this meal as “the most hopeful..., since we don’t yet know what atrocities the day may choose to visit upon us.”

Atwood has long recognized and played with breakfast’s invariability, as she once described life, itself, as “a kind of eternal breakfast” with its routine serving of daily expectations. In her fiction, literal breakfasts and their larger figurative counterparts (the unfolding life stories of the main characters) work in tandem as Atwood typically showcases anomalous meals that bring conflict, change, and the future sharply into focus. In *The Edible Woman* (1969), Atwood’s first published novel, chapter 1 opens with the protagonist’s morning egg having to be skipped and replaced with a bowl of cold cereal. As Nathalie Cooke reveals, the breakfast scene, hurried and unsatisfying, pre-pares the reader for this anxiety-ridden story where the future seems foreboding and off course. Readers must “start to search for clues about what might have gone wrong,” and eggs (as well as other foods) become symbolic of this difficult process of maturation as the character Marian McAlpin systematically loses her appetite.

For Atwood food and storytelling operate as important devices to create the worlds of the characters. Rituals can project a mental state into reality. Examining power as exercised through the body, Mervyn Nicholson concurs that while “sex is the means of species- reproduction ... eating is the means of self-reproduction... . To exist is an activity of daily transformation; one continually forms and transforms oneself, and the material means by which one performs this act of self-creation is food.”

...When imagining the world, Atwood admits that she “like[s] to wonder what people would have for breakfast. ...Breakfast can take you quite far.”

Text 2: *What I didn't put in my speech* by Claire Aman

After my speech at Davey's wedding, I head for the drinks table in a way that could only be described as agricultural. Davey's backyard is steep. I've got my elbows out and my legs are like cranks. Heavy duty, that's me these days. I think everyone liked the speech. They're smiling and clapping anyway. Davey and his bride are perfect on the veranda, like on a wedding cake. Nothing could be finer.

Up at the drinks table it's help yourself. I pull a beer out of the bathtub of ice. Davey's old friend Leo Addicoat takes the bottle from my fingers, twists off the top and hands it back to me. A pink hibiscus flops to and fro in his hatband as he moves his head. He looks like Leonard Cohen in that hat. I bet he's going bald. I haven't seen him for years. Davey and Leo used to share a house in the early eighties, when Davey first moved here to Sydney.

There's a woman next to him. She's fluttering a Chinese fan in tight little movements. He introduces me. 'This is Davey's cousin, Judith,' he tells her. 'Stunning speech, Judith,' she says to me, and her lips form a red smile. She tells me she didn't know Davey used to be reckless. 'I never knew he had that terrible fall,' she says.

Other people are touching my shoulder now. 'From Plumbago,' I tell them. 'On the north coast.'

'Is that anywhere near Byron?' someone asks. I suck on the bottle and the beer comes fizzing out in a rush, all over my dress.

'Steady,' says Leo. He takes a handful of purple serviettes from the table and dabs at me.

'Life's reckless,' I say. But the woman with the Chinese fan has forgotten me. She's turned to face the veranda. Now the bride's father is talking. It's starting to get dark and he's holding his speech up close to his face. He talks on and on about his daughter.

I decide to share a secret with Leo Addicoat.

'I've saved his life,' I whisper, looking straight ahead.

'Who?' says Leo.

Me and Jim Morrison,' I say, but Leo has pushed his hands into the bathtub and is fishing around for bottles. He opens a dark ale and puts his cold fingertips on my neck. 'Will you sing for us tonight, Jude?

'No way,' I tell him. Haven't sung for years.

I'm in a sweat from toiling up the garden so I wipe some ice over my cheeks. This dress is too tight around my armpits. There's a can of bourbon and coke winking at me from the bathtub and I can't resist it. What the hell. My duties are done.

Because I don't know most of the guests, I've spent the afternoon standing around with Leo. Davey and his new bride certainly a lot of friends. Davey's live in Sydney for thirty years now. He hasn't been back to Plumbago since his Dad, my Uncle Frank, died. Because us Hartigans are chronically prone to death and feuds, it turned out that I was the one and only family member coming to the wedding. That's why I got to make the speech.

I thought Leo would have made the speech. He and Davey go back a long way. I used to catch the train down from Plumbago to Sydney to stay at their place. They rented an old house in Ashfield, in a street called Palace Street. It was all sofas and bongs and flagons and the stereo full blast. Or we'd get stoned and drive to Stanwell Park in Davey's Torana and listen to Pink Floyd or The Doors while we waited for the sun to come up. We liked out music. I knew how to belt out a song when I was young. And Leo thought he could play guitar.

... It's cooling down. The weather has been unstable all day. We've had two squalls that sent us all running to the gazebos, followed by dazzling sunshine. 'It's more like Melbourne than Sydney.' Says Leo, and he goes to put his jacket on. When he misses the armhole and catches his arm, he gives me a comical, helpless look. He hasn't changed. I would have pretended it wasn't happening. I help him with the sleeve.

The lipstick one's wandered off. I asked him who she was. From Davey's work, he says. Nice, I say. He says yeah, no, sort of, and he scans the crowd. I think he could be lonely with his bold patch, so I haven't asked him if he has anyone.

'I hope it works out for Davey this time,' I say. This is Davey's third wedding. He and Christine have stepped off the veranda into a sea of wedding guests. Everyone wants to hug the. Davey's so tall his head rises above everyone else's Christine's white dress appears and disappears as the crowd tosses this way and that.

Section II: Electives

25 marks

Attempt ONE Question from Questions 2-6

Allow about 1 hour for this question

Answer the question on a separate page or in a separate writing booklet

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question demonstrating control of the use of language
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Question 2

Elective 1: Literary Homelands (25 Marks)

To what extent has the perspective of composers of the texts changed or confirmed your opinion about the reaction of people to different cultural experiences?

In your response, refer to TWO prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

- Prose Fiction
 - Aravind Adiga, *The White Tiger*
 - E M Forster, *A Passage to India*
 - Colm Tóibín, *Brooklyn*
- Poetry
 - Eileen Chong, *Burning Rice*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * Burning Rice
 - * Mid-autumn Mooncakes
 - * My Hakka Grandmother
 - * Shophouse, Victoria Street
 - * Chinese Ginseng
 - * Winter Meeting
 - * Singapore
- Drama for
 - Andrew Bovell, *The Secret River* by Kate Grenville – An adaptation the stage by Andrew Bovell
- Film – Sarah Gavron, *Brick Lane*

Question 3 - Elective 2 Worlds of Upheaval (25 Marks)

To what extent has the perspective of composers of the texts challenged traditional, or your own, social values?

In your response, refer to TWO prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**

- Elizabeth Gaskell, *North and South*
- Mary Shelley, *Frankenstein*
- Madeleine Thien, *Do Not Say We Have Nothing*

- **Poetry**

- Seamus Heaney, *Opened Ground: Poems 1966–1996*

The prescribed poems are:

- * *Digging*
- * *The Strand at Lough Beg*
- * *Casualty*
- * *Funeral Rites*
- * *Whatever You Say Say Nothing*
- * *Triptych*

- **Drama**

- Samuel Beckett, *Waiting for Godot*

- **Film**

- Fritz Lang, *Metropolis*

Question 4 - Elective 3: Reimagined Worlds (25 Marks)

“Fiction is like a spider’s web, attached ever so slightly perhaps, but still attached to life at all four corners. Often the attachment is scarcely perceptible.”

Virginia Woolf

To what extent has the perspective of composers of the texts made you aware of this attachment and offered insights into the values of the world in which you live?

In your response, refer to TWO prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Italo Calvino, *If on a Winter’s Night a Traveller*
 - Ursula Le Guin, *The Left Hand of Darkness*
 - Jonathan Swift, *Gulliver’s Travels*
- **Poetry**
 - Samuel Taylor Coleridge, *Samuel Taylor Coleridge: The Complete Poems*
The prescribed poems are:
 - * *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* (1834)
 - * *The Eolian Harp*
 - * *Kubla Khan*
 - * *Christabel*
 - Tracy K Smith, *Life on Mars*
The prescribed poems are:
 - * *Sci-Fi*
 - * *My God, It’s Full of Stars*
 - * *Don’t You Wonder, Sometimes?*
 - * *The Universe: Original Motion Picture Soundtrack*
 - * *The Universe as Primal Scream*
- **Film**
 - Guillermo Del Toro, *Pan’s Labyrinth*

Question 5 - Elective 4: Literary Mindscapes (25 Marks)

Evaluate how the texts depict the pathways between speculation and conviction through their representation of literary mindscapes.

In your response, refer to TWO prescribed texts and at least ONE text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - William Faulkner, *As I Lay Dying*
 - Gail Jones, *Sixty Lights*
 - Katherine Mansfield, *The Collected Stories*
 - * *Prelude*
 - * *Je ne Parle pas Français*
 - * *Bliss*
 - * *Psychology*
 - * *The Daughters of the Late Colonel*
- **Poetry**
 - Emily Dickinson, *The Complete Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *I felt a Funeral, in my Brain*
 - * *This is my letter to the World*
 - * *I died for Beauty – but was scarce*
 - * *I had been hungry, all the Years*
 - * *Because I could not stop for Death*
 - * *My Life had stood – a Loaded Gun*
 - * *A word dropped careless on a Page*
- **Drama**
 - William Shakespeare, *Hamlet*
- **Film**
 - Sofia Coppola, *Lost in Translation*

Question 6 - Elective 5: Intersecting Worlds (25 Marks)

To what extent has the perspective of composers of the texts influenced your response to the value of the natural world?

In your response, refer to TWO prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Melissa Harrison, *Clay*
 - Alex Miller, *Journey to the Stone Country*
 - Annie Proulx, *The Shipping News*
- **Nonfiction**
 - Tim Winton, *Island Home*
- **Poetry**
 - William Wordsworth, *William Wordsworth: The Major Works*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Lines written a few miles above Tintern Abbey*
 - * *Three years she grew in sun and shower*
 - * *My heart leaps up when I behold*
 - * *Resolution and Independence*
 - * *The world is too much with us*
 - * *Ode ('There was a time')*
 - * *The Solitary Reaper*
 - * *The Prelude (1805)* – Book One, lines 1– 67, 271– 441
- **Film**
 - Daniel Nettheim, *The Hunter*

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